

EDUCATION

The students who quietly disappear

A student stops showing up, and weeks pass before anyone who could help notices. They usually had a problem that could be fixed. They did not know who to ask.

How might we reach one student before they disappear, in a way they would actually answer?

START HERE

Think of someone who faded out of a class or school. What was the first sign? How would they have wanted someone to reach out?

WHERE AI CAN WORK

- Reading a short reply and picking the right help: tutoring, aid, food, counseling
- Writing a message that sounds human
- Turning “where do I go for this?” into a real office and real hours

YOU COULD BUILD

- A check-in assistant that hands the student to the right person
- A campus navigator for new students
- A weekly summary for a counselor, with a drafted message for each student who went quiet

THINK ABOUT (THIS IS SCORED)

Being labeled “at risk” can follow a student. Who sees that label? Can the student? Does your outreach feel like care or like being watched?

YOUR DAY

- 9:45** Meet your squad. Read this page.
- 10:00** Pick one real person with this problem.
- 10:30** Problem sentence read to your coach.
- 10:30** Build version one.
- 11:45** Lunch
- 12:30** Finish. Make your risks slide.
- 1:10** Stop building. Practice the pitch.
- 1:30** Pitch to your track: 3 minutes.
- 2:15** Finals and awards, Dyer Hall

HOW YOU ARE SCORED

- 25 Problem clarity:** real, specific, belongs to a person
- 25 Use of AI:** AI does real work, not decoration
- 20 Feasibility:** someone could use it and it would matter
- 15 Responsible design:** bias, privacy, who could be harmed
- 15 The pitch:** clear, honest, everyone speaks

Squad name: _____ Who we are building for: _____

YOUR PROBLEM SENTENCE — write it before you build anything

_____ (a real person) struggles with _____
because _____. We will build _____
so they can _____.

YOUR 3-MINUTE PITCH

Meet the person (30 sec). Their problem today (30). What you built and what the AI does, shown live if you can (75). What could go wrong and your safeguard (30). What comes next (15).

RULES

Coaches and mentors help, but never build or present for you. Never type real private information about anyone into an AI tool. Check what the AI tells you; it can be confidently wrong. A working app, a set-up AI assistant, a clickable mockup, or a clear plan with one worked example can all win.

NOTES & SKETCHES

Toolkit links and all six challenges
longbeachaihackathon.org/briefs

